

Caltech Book Club Constitution

Article I: Name

The name of this organization shall be the Caltech Book Club.

Article II: Purpose

The purpose of the Caltech Book Club is to foster a community of readers at Caltech by organizing regular meetings for the discussion of books selected by the members. The club aims to encourage thoughtful dialogue and provide a space for members to share their perspectives on the books read.

Article III: Membership

1. Membership in the Caltech Book Club is open to all members of the Caltech community.
2. Members can opt in or out of participating in individual books.
3. New members are welcome to join at any point in time, given they catch up to the agreed upon stopping point.
4. Once a member starts a book, they are expected to participate in all meetings discussing that book.

Article IV: Meetings

1. The club will hold meetings every other Thursday from 7:00 PM to 8:00 PM.
2. Meetings will involve discussions on pre-agreed reading material, with food optionally provided.
3. Members are expected to read 100-120 pages of the current book every two weeks, without exceeding the agreed-upon stopping point for the meeting.

Article V: Book Selection Process

1. Book selection will follow a Reddit-style voting system.
 - a. Book proposal and voting will occur over a four day period.
 - b. Members are encouraged to propose books during the first two days of the voting period and then vote in the final two days.
 - c. An upvote signifies general interest in reading the book.
 - d. A downvote is used only if a member strongly opposes reading the book.
2. One to two books will be selected per academic term.

Article VI: Conduct of Discussions

1. Members will follow the "2X2 Rule," meaning they should wait either two minutes or for two other people to speak before speaking again.
2. Members should not talk over others and must be respectful, open-minded, and considerate of privacy.
3. Members are encouraged to follow the recommendations of the Living Room Conversation Agreements listed below.

- a. Be curious and listen to understand.
 - b. Note any common ground as well as any differences.
 - c. Be authentic and welcome that from others.
 - d. Be purposeful and to the point.
 - e. Own and guide the conversation.
4. Discussions within the club are governed by the Chatham House Rule, meaning members are free to share content discussed outside of the club but should not attribute specific comments to individual members.

Article VII: Officers

1. The club shall have officers to facilitate meetings, manage communications, and organize book selections.
2. Any issues with discussion topics, members, or general discomfort should be reported to the officers, who will attempt to address the concerns.

Article VIII: Amendments

Amendments to this constitution can be proposed by any member of the club and will be passed by a simple majority vote during a regular meeting.

Article IX: Ratification

This constitution is to be ratified at the first meeting of each academic year. Amendments and revisions are encouraged to reflect the ever changing needs of the book club.